#1 WTF is Metaverse? WTF is with Nikhil Kamath ft. Tanmay Bhat, Umang Bedi & Aprameya Radhakrishna

[Speaker 1] (0:00 - 2:48)

It's funny how I suddenly feel conscious when the camera is on and I know about it, right? Like I was so happy talking like before that. Why do you want to touch dinosaurs?

How do I compete with that? He had made two jokes and now he's found his angle and he won't stop. First, nothing is going to work until I just maybe sleep better.

So maybe I should try that thing. So maybe at 110, I'm going to call you, Nikhil. You'll be like, yo, that Vigovi thing you were talking about.

But is there a number when it changes? Like is six not enough and eight enough? Do you have that?

Like sleep? Eight. Eight is a good number.

You should go close enough to eight. And if you don't, you just make it a habit. Bro, Nikhil, if you sleep eight hours, you're going to trade like a madman.

You're going to all of a sudden be like 65% profit today. Dude, if you slept eight hours, you would be short one week ago. Like you would know this shit.

Nah, it's just that some random crap on TV, some work, some game on my phone. These are the things that keep me up. It's not some fancy work.

Doesn't Nitin like sleep really well? He speaks a lot about health. No, he doesn't.

He gets like maybe six hours or seven, max, pushing it. He sleeps early, wakes up early, but... That's what I do.

I go to bed by 10.30. How much do you sleep? I sleep like easy eight hours. Really?

I don't wake up at all. So Aparamohan is a genuinely very well-rounded guy. Everything is right about him.

Like, you know, the college he went to, what he did at work, his wife, his daughter. Generally, he's a very well-rounded guy. Eight hours?

Eight hours, yeah. He sings, he's in a band, he has a band. I'll sleep at 12 and I'll wake up by 8 and I'm ready.

And how do you wake up though? Like how do you guys wake up? Without an alarm.

Without an alarm? With an alarm. With many alarms.

Oh, Sebi doesn't call you to wake you up? No, no. Starts at 7 a.m. The first alarm is 7, the last one is 7.45 a.m. In between that, I have 10. Amazing. But what year was this when you lost this weight? 2018.

Actually, 17 middle to 18 June. I've been constant largely from 18 June. And then did you start bulking up after that?

I did. I did. But then, you know, you can't maintain it at a constant rate.

You have to kind of go up and down, which is the right thing to do. Because you can't train your body to do just one thing.

[Speaker 2] (2:48 - 2:58)

I've had a peak weight though. I've weighed 115. I've gone down to 90.

I've come back to 95, 96 right now.

[Speaker 1] (2:58 - 3:00)

What took you to 115?

[Speaker 2] (3:01 - 3:20)

115 was my first startup. Taxi for sure. So I would eat at home.

I would eat another breakfast after I reached office. Because I would have gone at 8, 9 o'clock. Then I would eat two lunches because I would have taken my lunch box.

And I had a team lunch or some meeting.

[Speaker 1] (3:20 - 3:29)

Why don't you guys introduce yourself a little bit? Everybody knows Tanmay. So he needs no introduction.

But maybe like do 30 seconds. Yeah.

[Speaker 2] (3:30 - 3:50)

I'm Upramaya and I am from Bangalore. I'm a Kannadiga. I, you know, I'm known as, most known as an entrepreneur.

I ran, I founded and ran Taxi for sure before this. Sold to Ola. Now I run Koo, which is a social

media platform competing against Twitter globally.

[Speaker 1] (3:51 - 3:53)

So that's me. How are you feeling about Elon?

[Speaker 2] (3:54 - 4:00)

Elon is awesome. Whatever he does makes news. And that makes microblogging sexier than what it was.

[Speaker 1] (4:01 - 4:07)

We're in the same space. So Elon has been good for Koo? Absolutely.

I think so. I think.

[Speaker 2] (4:09 - 4:34)

So he's taken it more west than what it was already. And we're more, you know, languages. We're more adapting to countries.

We're more creator focused in terms of, you know, we want creators to monetize better. We want to give them more tools. You know, all of those things.

So I think we're kind of like the opposite of what Twitter has been. And, you know, we don't know where Elon is taking Twitter right now. So it's all good.

[Speaker 1] (4:34 - 4:49)

Upramaya probably has his notifications on for Elon's tweets. Every time Elon is tweeting out some feature, Upramaya is like, tried that, doesn't work. But you know what he was telling me the other day?

In Brazil, apparently the politicians Koo first and then tweet. Interesting.

[Speaker 2] (4:50 - 5:09)

Wow. That's insane. The president of Brazil is on Koo.

You know, the people love Koo there. Like a friend of mine was in, was at the World Cup and he found, he was in the Brazil match and he found some Brazilians who were taking photos. He asked him, is this going on Instagram?

They said, no, we have a new network called Koo.

[Speaker 1] (5:10 - 5:14)

So it's really. What happened that all of a sudden you went vertical in Brazil?

[Speaker 2] (5:15 - 5:52)

So we keep doing our hacky things, right? Like one thing we do is, you know, we keep advertising articles about us. One article is second largest microblog in the world.

And we kept advertising that to journalists and across the world. And one Brazil journalist was famous, picked it up and started talking. Nice.

And another thing that added to it, of course, they were looking for an alternative than Twitter. And third one is, which was the most important, which is why it became viral, is because Koo means ass in Portuguese. Really?

[Speaker 4] (5:52 - 5:53)

I didn't know that.

[Speaker 2] (5:53 - 5:57)

So it became cool to actually talk about it.

[Speaker 1] (5:58 - 8:29)

Follow my Koo. So Tanmay, what have you been up to of late? Everybody has seen you on TV, on many different platforms for more than a decade now.

If I'm on TV, it's probably bad news. Not many people know that you're very popular amongst the fairer sex as well, especially with the weight loss and all of that. Tell us a bit about that and how it works.

Weren't we supposed to talk about the metaverse, guys? Nikhil is the worst wingman in the world. He's the worst wingman.

I told Nikhil, I'm single. What help do you need? You're already getting everything you need, right?

I told Nikhil, I'm single and I'm trying to date. And we're having a get-together at Nikhil's house. And I'm talking to some girl.

Nikhil shows up. He's like, hey, have you met Tanmay? He's very attractive to the opposite sex.

I'm like, what are you doing? This is not how you wingman. You just cue and you leave.

I don't think I'm the alpha in that sense. I'm known for, oh, he laughs. Women like that?

Harmless. Harmless guy who's laughing is unattractive. Just to be clear, no one's watching me for the attractiveness.

He's harmless. He's laughing at me, so why not? But once they watch you, you automatically become even more attractive, right?

When you meet them in person. What a pathetic man you are. I made two jokes and now he's found his angle and he won't stop.

I've seen that people pay money to watch other people eat food. It's a thing. But I don't think people like us.

This is my question. No, dude, but this is true in some sense. I met a friend of mine from school after 30 years in New York.

She wanted to eat a hot dog from one of those stands outside New York. I didn't realize that there are so many varieties of hot dogs there. It's really big.

You can't eat it with one hand. It's pretty messy. But apparently, I Googled this and saw it.

[Speaker 2] (8:29 - 8:34)

She basically came back to me and said, the hottest thing about Tom Cruise is him eating.

[Speaker 1] (8:35 - 14:46)

And I was like, what? This is a woman telling me, so I'm going to believe it. She's like, why don't you just Google search Tom Cruise eating?

It's a movie, by the way, from Meet Joe Black to Tom Gunn, he's eating. Maybe we should just catch up when you poop. There are women who watch him?

What does your company do? So we have a family of apps. One is in news, which is Daily Hunt.

It's the largest news aggregator in 16 different local languages. Then the other we launched at the ban of TikTok in India. You launched the ban?

No, no. At the ban of TikTok in India, we launched Josh. Oh, yeah, of course, Josh.

And we have a third app called Public Vibe, which is a hyper-local video-only content app in 15 different languages. They raise money at some ridiculous number. You haven't seen?

It's all over the news. Some 7 billion, 8 billion, something like that. 5.

Daily Hunt is huge. How many people work at Daily Hunt now? Employees is 2,700.

But I think the creator ecosystem that we work with is about 150,000 people on the Daily Hunt site. And millions of people on the website. Can I ask you a question?

Do you think old-school media is dying? And these creators will take over? I have a 5-year wait on this question.

Do you think it's answered already? What is old-school media? Like TV channels, newspapers, The Economist, BBC.

I'd love to go after you. Because I'm in the midst of the storm. My two cents.

I think at a high level, any business, if you don't transform yourself every five to seven years, you're going to die. So the average lifespan of any company on S&P is 15 years. So all businesses in my mind are destined to die.

However grave that sounds. But coming to the specific question. But they've been around for 100 years.

But if you also think about where the world has come from, the first way that people got access to information was the newspaper. And so it kind of liberated society at so many levels. From the world that we came from, which was more a land of dictators and rulers and so on and so forth.

So it had its place in time. But if you look at any place in the world, newspaper readership is dying. Print circulation is dying, or slowly dying.

But a lot of the smart companies are morphing to go behind the paywall with very premium content. And you named Economist, New York Times is a great example. So my view is that newspapers will have to morph their model.

It can be a add-on, but their main business will be, you know, it'll have to go and be digitally driven. TV I'm a lot more positive about. Because TV and digital kind of work together.

TV is kind of morphing into a digital device, right? All TVs are becoming Android or Apple TVs or smart TVs, right? But you don't mean TV news channels, you mean content.

I mean content, right? So if you think about it today, what is TV? TV is basically, it's coming through broadcast.

So broadcast will go away. It'll all become IT-based, right? And so, you know, for instance, you and I read The Business Today, right?

I didn't even know Business Today is a partner on Devihan, so that's how I got to know. But they launched a TV channel, which is pure IT. And it's just, so it's not on YouTube.

It's a, it's beamed on TVs through IT and through an app, right? So it's quite an interesting play

that I think all TVs ultimately will become smart. They're already there.

They're already there. I have a TV, but I haven't seen what's being broadcasted. I choose what I watch.

How did Bitcoin, Rutten, the whole crypto winter in a way affect the influencers? Because they were sponsoring a lot of them, right? Yeah, there were some cases of, there were some cases of, you know, an exchange went down, a couple of influencers had done deals.

I know in America, a lot of influencers participated in like open pump and dump, right? Like people have, people on Twitter, they pointed out that, you know, said influencer said buy here and then said sell here. And when they said, when they said buy, you could see their wallet, their wallet selling when they said buy and that kind of thing.

So those guys got wrecked. In fact, the biggest one was Logan Paul. That was the biggest news.

So it was the news the last couple of months. He launched an NFT project. Then another independent investigative YouTuber called Coffeezilla made a four part series that got over 30 million views.

30 million views. 30 million views saying that how Logan Paul scammed his followers. Logan Paul was forced to come out and address the thing and he apologized and he said I'm going to make this project right.

He had launched a crypto game, so to say. So the winter was pretty bad. A lot of YouTubers had a ton of trouble.

In general, influencers would be better off supporting developer initiatives over any kind of shilling of any kind of token. I think that's just the smarter route to go. It's also the more productive route.

And you find yourself in a new community that'll actually appreciate you because very few mainstream influencers actually talk to developers, so to say. So when I make some sort of coding joke, they feel like, oh my God, this is about me. I didn't even think you'd be interested.

Yeah, I think that's fair.

[Speaker 2] (14:47 - 15:42)

So you know how there was only Didi on TV and everybody had to only watch that and they had no choice. And then channels came up. Everybody picked their channel.

Now you can subscribe to different channels. So that's what's going to happen overall. Some channels you won't even know exist.

So personalization, as he said, is going to go up. You'll live in a world of sports and never come

out and you'll not even know who Shah Rukh Khan is. Again, 15-20 years ago, a movie would launch on Friday.

Nothing else was there. Everybody would go to the movie. Now that craze is gone.

Friday morning, we don't even associate it with movie releases anymore. TikTok is like a micro-Bollywood movie.

[Speaker 4] (15:43 - 15:43)

Josh.

[Speaker 2] (15:47 - 15:51)

Josh is a micro-Bollywood movie. I will coup that.

[Speaker 1] (15:53 - 16:17)

I'm not selling anything today. You're just shorting some stocks. No, no.

Yeah, so you were making a point. Yeah, so I was saying, the guy who entertains us for 30 seconds on a short video app, you will never watch him in a 3-hour movie.

[Speaker 2] (16:20 - 16:29)

Only Shah Rukh Khan can do a 3-hour movie and get our attention. So that's been split into millions of people who are talented for 30 seconds and can entertain us for 3 hours.

[Speaker 1] (16:29 - 21:32)

Yeah, so the framework was that any platform that enables you to be a rockstar, those took prominence. And the barrier to become a rockstar kept getting lower and lower over the last couple of decades. It began with YouTube.

Can I tell you, I went to have a drink with Tanmay once to a bar. People were hounding him. He was like Shah Rukh Khan.

When was this? Things have changed when we went to that place in Denmark. There were like 40-50 of them.

How many? 40-50 people? Easy?

I mean, whatever. But if Tanmay, if you made a movie, I have a couple of scripts actually. That'll be a good experiment.

If you had to make a movie, what would you make it about? I would make it for digital. We want

people under the age of 18 to watch this one.

That I don't guarantee. That my movie will be for folks under 18. But I would make it for digital.

I would make something funny. And how I would optimise is, because in life I am an under-promise, over-deliver kind of person. So I would do a low budget.

Something that makes whatever OTT platform was buying it, feel like, oh, this person comes with a certain distribution. And for that, this value was great. So I get to do more.

That makes a lot of sense. This is how I would do it. In fact, I called it many years ago, when a lot of these OTT platforms were coming.

I had a bunch of meetings with them. And I kept telling them then, saying, listen to me. The way for you to guarantee distribution is to find other people who have distribution.

Just get them to make shit. It's going to work. Cut to today we see Bhuvan Bam's show, number one on the platform for three weeks straight.

Cut to Bassi just posted ten minutes ago, trending number one in India. Zakir Khan, last three specials, trending number one in India for three weeks straight. That thesis completely played out.

Number one podcast on Spotify, run by a gamer who has 12 million people following him on YouTube. So like I was saying, the barrier to become a rock star kept getting lower and lower and lower. So the question that I keep asking myself is, what's the next thing where the barrier to entry becomes so low that everybody is able to do it?

I had a bunch of questions about the metaverse. I looked online and did not get good answers. Everything was too confusing.

I watched a bunch of videos, including the one from Mark Zuckerberg, which was like two hours long or something like that. And I was researching the meta stock, in all fairness, for the last six months. At the valuation, not of today, but of one and a half, two months ago, I thought it was fairly valued, 13, 14 times multiples.

For context, they were earning X amount of money. The company's value was 14X. And in India, most of the tech companies you invest in, in our ecosystem, the startup ecosystem, you have to add like one or two zeros on top of that.

14X is cheap, actually. And in many ways, they spend a lot more on innovation than many of the companies here. So the stock looked very appealing to me.

And credit to be given to Mark for all the acquisitions he has made in the past. More often than not, he might have appeared wrong initially, but eventually he turned out to be right. No, but a

decade later, look at all the things that Zuck got right.

The amount of shit that was flung at Zuck for the last decade. And today you look at him and you realize, holy shit, he's gotten so many things right. And he's been attacked for things that are not...

Like after Elon took over Twitter, right? Censorship, this, that, and all. All of a sudden, Zuck looks like the nice guy.

He took everything without saying a word, without leaning into the chaos like Elon did. The other thing is that the metaverse became such a massive deal, part of which is because Facebook became meta, right? Like it's a big bold step.

You know, I can't help but think about, all right, Apple has attacked Facebook's ad strategy by the whole privacy thing on the iPhone. Apple's biggest advantage is they have a hardware device. Zuck just needs to make...

He has to ensure the next 20, 25 years, he needs to get hardware right. And his big bet is Oculus or the metaverse, which is going to be a thing where we all sit down and we're just always constantly going to be in it. Which we kind of are already because my screen time is like 10 hours a day on the phone.

So let's try and define what metaverse is because I still don't know. What is metaverse? What is metaverse to Apu?

[Speaker 2] (21:33 - 22:24)

So I think Tanmay was about to say that today we already disappear into a different universe. And that universe is based on our taste. Like if I want to get into the lifestyle universe, I'll open Instagram, right?

What people are eating, where they're going, you know, all of that is the universe of lifestyle that I live in, right? If I want to get into the world of thoughts and opinions, you'll log into a social network like a Koo or a Twitter, you know, that's where you go in and you live in that world of thoughts and opinions and hence the fights are more, opinions are more, you know. So we're logging into universes already.

Just that it is two dimensional. It is a very sad experience, while the experiences are great today on the phone.

[Speaker 1] (22:25 - 23:25)

So do you think you being on Instagram on your phone can also be called metaverse? I think the metaversal habit is here. But what people, first of all, it's a made up name.

It's a made up word. It's that novelist who wrote that Snow Crash. What was this?

Where did this come from? I think 20-30 years ago, I can't remember his name, but I was watching his interview. He wrote a book called Snow Crash, in which he, I hope the name is right, but in that he described a version of the metaverse.

A decade ago, there was a movie called Ready Player One, which was like, oh, you put something in and there's a version of this in the Matrix as well, which is, oh, you get plugged into this world via some device where your physical location is transformed into something. Do you think you have to be transformed into another location to truly call it metaverse? Or even your phone can qualify for metaverse?

[Speaker 2] (23:25 - 23:48)

I think logging into our phone is a universe in itself. And each app is a universe, right? And the more immersive that experience gets, the more meta it becomes, right?

So we're there. Like we're logging off reality. We're in the, everybody's looking like this.

That's already a metaversal experience. Would you agree with that?

[Speaker 1] (23:49 - 24:12)

Yeah, I think the behavior is already there. But I mean, have all of you tried Oculus? Yeah.

Look, there are moments where it's pretty amazing, right? And I truly feel like, holy shit, so many other things could be amazing if you could do it. Like I've tried some fitness stuff.

I've tried some music stuff. I don't know what you're actually thinking of. We all do.

[Speaker 4] (24:13 - 24:14)

We all do.

[Speaker 1] (24:15 - 24:27)

No, but of course. And haptics are not in place yet. It's the Seinfeld joke, right?

Which is any new technology, the first thing it gets adapted to is ****. In India, the version is it comes in a Punjabi song.

[Speaker 2] (24:27 - 24:28)

Yeah, exactly.

[Speaker 1] (24:28 - 27:09)

Punjabi music artists get it first. So Snapchat's a thing. There's a song about Snapchat.

That's how I bought Bitcoin. I heard it in a Punjabi song. And Iman, what do you think of the metaverse?

So, you know, if you look at it from where it's defined, the way it's defined, it's three dimensional. When somebody says metaverse, what is the first picture which comes in your head? I think the first picture that comes, at least the way it's being sold and told is...

Also, you were the ex-India CEO of Meta. Yeah. And Insta, so...

Yeah. So the way I look at it, Nikhil, is it's defined as something which is three dimensional and virtual and augmented reality and virtual reality and all of those buzzwords. But I tend to think of, and I actually defer on my opinion on the Optimus, even though Meta's a great company and everything else, right?

But when you think about a device that is once so bulky to cost $400 or $500, whatever it does, the new version, right? It's for very few elite experiences, right? I'm going to push Apoorv's thought a little bit in terms of what he said.

So when you're getting into a phone, imagine a world wherein your phone and your browser or an app or whatever gave you a three dimensional view. You had that cardboard box version of something, right? You had cardboard and then, of course, Google introduced glasses.

And at the end of the day, the form factor can keep shrinking, but it's really uncomfortable to wear something, to experience something. So the way I look at technology is, it's very simple, right? Moore's law.

If you look at the rate of compute and the cost, it gets cheaper every decade, right? And exponentially. Now, today the problem is if I told you, hey, for charity, let's just run a short video platform.

Okay. It's prohibitively expensive because all your money is going to your cloud providers, right? It's just really expensive.

Moosh. We call it moosh. That's a good one.

We'll pick that up in a little bit. But imagine that I told you that, hey, can we have the ability of just extending what Appu said, bringing in everything that is provided on the Oculus or through a three dimensional experience on a simple phone. And then what that would do is it would totally democratize it.

So I'm a fan of democratization of technology, right? What makes TikTok or Facebook or in our context, in my world, you know, Ku or Josh or Daily Hunt viral is when, or YouTube, right? Is

when everyone can access it on any device, on any surface.

[Speaker 2] (27:09 - 27:15)

But for that to happen in a three dimensional, you know, feel of an experience.

[Speaker 1] (27:16 - 27:18)

We just have to let Moore's law do its thing.

[Speaker 2] (27:18 - 27:18)

Exactly.

[Speaker 1] (27:18 - 27:52)

The amount of compute in the backend, right? It's going to be crazy. Already the new Oculus is already better than the last one.

There are versions of the Oculus. I tried something called Unreal, which is a simpler version. It's a much smaller thing and you can actually put it on top of your glasses.

They're almost clip-ons. And they don't have the depth of Oculus. Like it doesn't cover your whole face.

It's just way smaller. So you can already see that, like things are progressing. Like makes me almost feel like Google Glass was way ahead.

[Speaker 2] (27:53 - 27:53)

Yeah.

[Speaker 1] (27:53 - 28:19)

That's an interesting segment. We should probably move on to, where do we think the metaverse will first be useful and who will adopt it first? Perfect.

Hi. So we're four guys from India. We're wondering what the metaverse is and start from the beginning.

Maybe you can tell us what the metaverse is and we'll lead with questions. Also, if you could, could you please introduce yourself for like a minute?

[Speaker 3] (28:20 - 29:32)

Oh, absolutely. So Marco Stagliano, I'm founder and CEO of AnotherOne. AnotherOne is a web-free fashion digital platform that offers access for digital products in the fashion industry for users

in order to create, exchange, and also redeem the physical assets that are linked to the digital assets and unlocking opportunity for monetization, but also immersive experience in the metaverse for brands and creators.

And we work with different metaverse. We work with different brands. We enhance the fashion industry in terms of like waste.

We try not to create inventory and waste for the production line. And also we create an environment where the users themselves, they're not clients, they become members. So they can be rewarded, that they can have monetization opportunities.

So let's say an ecosystem that have in mind all the stakeholders in the fashion industry. And this is AnotherOne.

[Speaker 1] (29:33 - 29:55)

So we were having a conversation first about actually defining what the metaverse is. And we were wondering, or we were debating how immersive does something have to be to be called metaverse? Would you define metaverse as something that you can interact with through a medium like VR or AR?

[Speaker 3] (29:57 - 31:08)

No, actually not. My concept of metaverse is something that already existed in different form and shape. The technology allow us to have a different configuration of the metaverse.

But for me, metaverse is an ecosystem. It could be physical or digital that create a complex aggregate of rules, connection and interlink with the people in it. That is not specifically related to a location or an area as like the ecosystem as we know as government.

If I may do an example, I'm old enough likely to have played board game. So back in the days, there was Dungeon and Dragon. So if you think about Dungeon and Dragon, that is a metaverse.

The only difference is that you don't have VR, you don't have metaverse, you don't have digital experience. You just have your imagination as the sense to perceive the ecosystem and the world that was created for that reason. So I do believe that metaverse was existing already, but now we have the tools to explore more immersive experience.

[Speaker 1] (31:08 - 37:20)

I'll get back to what Marco said. Maybe pose a question I can introduce myself. So it also depends on the use case.

In addition to Marco's defined, it has been existing since a long time. Gaming has been defining

and driving it in very simple sense. It's a network of interconnected 3D spaces.

And if you look at the evolution of the internet, it's been a medium where some of our five senses have been digitized in some sense. It started off with digitizing the sense of hearing, the sense of sight, and the metaverse is just taking them, putting them in an immersive experience. And now with haptics, we are digitizing the sense of touch.

The only thing I think we can't really digitize in the metaverse is the sense of smell and sense of taste. As long as you can transfer all of your human senses into a virtual world, that is a metaverse. And it depends on the use case.

Use cases like gaming, you don't have to be fully immersed. Your imagination can take you there. Use cases like virtual tourism or shopping, you need to be fully immersed.

You need to go around with your family, get a sense of social feedback when you're purchasing a product and do that thing, right? What do you think the first killer app is going to be that gets a hundred million people to use it? I think...

You can say ****. It's not going to be a binary event where the first app is going to crack a hundred million. It's going to be a slow grind.

There will be multiple apps driving 1 million to 5 million kind of MAU paces. What's the most popular one right now? VR Chat.

VR Chat? Yeah. Is it like Roulette Chat or it's just two people talking to each other in VR?

It's like Yahoo chat rooms, but in virtual reality. So you can enter chat rooms. And some people have created chat rooms where you can do things like play a game of billiards or some people have put in a shooting range.

They have introduced some interesting creative tools where you can paint together and do stuff like that. But there are inherent technology problems. Any room cannot support more than 30 to 40 concurrent users stably, otherwise the room starts collapsing.

There's too many network complications that start popping up. So that's why game engines become very important, right? Companies that have built game engines and own IP across game engines really have a huge advantage in building and defining the metaverse.

So what's going to be really... The app that will drive critical mass in the metaverse, it's going to be sports or any kind of content that drives mass engagement, right? Sports has this very tribalistic feeling where millions of people watch it together and if a million people watch it together in a stadium and whichever company solves that problem first, either in segments or intelligently through simulating that experience, imagine watching the IPL or the FIFA World Cup in the metaverse from your home.

Who do you think is the leader in this space? Which company? Who do you think will make money off the metaverse first?

Too early to bet on leaders? Bet on people. John Carmack is the guy who's considered...

See, we can't really bet on people. At least we can buy stocks. Sorry, I'm stupid.

Who is John Carmack? John Carmack is a legend for all of us gamers. Anyone who's been into gaming since the last two decades has idolized him.

He's a game designer, software engineer. What has he designed? He built the first game engine in the world.

He redefined immersion. Until then, games were basically your console games that you've seen. Contra, Mario, console-based games.

Suddenly, this guy churns out a game engine and you see Doom 3, where you're traveling in a 3D space and interacting, shooting, killing people and this whole immersive experience. John went on to create a few iterations. That spawned a lot of spinoffs.

Unreal Engine, what it is today, is basically... Oh, he's the founder of Unreal? No, no, no.

John Carmack created the first game engine from which the Unreal Engine spun off. The whole gaming ecosystem basically spun off from what he built. Would you say amongst large companies, it's between Microsoft and Meta?

Unreal is an independent company. You don't know anything about Unreal? Oh, no.

Unreal is... How much longer before Meta buys Unreal? They won't tell.

Tell us a bit more about Unreal. It's the most popular game engine in the world. Maybe I'll share screen and show you what Unreal can do.

Bro, they released everything. Unreal Engine is the engine on which games are built on top of. And they've built all these amazing tools.

They just released something a couple of months ago which enables anyone can come in and they can create a game on this. It's like Dragon Drop. Dragon Drop.

And the textures are insanely realistic. What is the new engine called? It's called something, right?

The tool that everyone can build. It's Unreal Engine 5.1. Unreal Engine 5. 5.

[Speaker 2] (37:21 - 37:28)

It seems like Metaverse is also taking the path of the internet, right? Like chat rooms, then gaming.

[Speaker 1] (37:31 - 38:27)

Do you guys see my screen? Yeah. This is just a feature on Unreal Engine.

This is called MetaHumans. Basically, none of these human beings are real. They are avatars generated by blending and learning a combination of virtual assets.

This is the best virtual asset you've ever seen, right? I've never seen something this good. It's amazing.

I need to get you in a game. You've got to play some of these games. They're too good.

One controversial question. Why does Neverland, I forget the destination, the first Metaverse destination where you could host Horizon World or Neverland, I forget what it's called, but it has 26 DAU or daily active users, which is insane, right? And it's valued at a billion dollars.

Why would this fail? Central. Sorry.

[Speaker 3] (38:28 - 38:34)

Decentralized. 291 active users. Out of September 2022.

It's awful.

[Speaker 1] (38:35 - 39:03)

So there's all kinds of companies which are like, crypto companies, so to say. They tokenize first and they're building the game. A lot of these NFT projects.

NFTs are, yeah. NFTs have a real use. You can get to that.

That's a different thing. But the question I always had is how the hell are they going to compete with Facebook, Meta and Microsoft? How can they compete?

How can a 10 person engineering team compete with that?

[Speaker 3] (39:04 - 40:39)

I do have a question though. Do you intend a Metaverse like any technology virtual simulation or a Metaverse is based on like all the environment being traced on blockchain? Because this is the fundamental difference between like Metaverse and virtual experience.

Because with our company, we build experience in the central end. We build experience in

Sandbox. Now we bought a building in Altaverse.

That is another, let's say, kind of Metaverse, but I call it simulation. That use Unreal Engine 5. Very good graphic because the central and Sandbox, of course, is not that compelling.

But the problem is that it's not a real like Metaverse as the concept of Sandbox and the central end. Because in Sandbox and the central end, all the lands are NFTs. And all the building NFTs, all the structures that are there, are built on a traceable way.

And then the goal of the Metaverse, and that's why the central end and Sandbox and all other Metaverse, like regular Metaverse, let's call them, have a different, have a lower graphic. Because the way to process all this image and trace all this transaction in the blockchain, as of now, it's impossible because the technology is not that sophisticated. So that's, I think, the first distinction between a Metaverse and...

Sorry?

[Speaker 1] (40:39 - 40:48)

What do people do after buying this land? Like on the Metaverse, you said you bought a building or a land. What happens next?

You wait.

[Speaker 3] (40:50 - 41:12)

So, exactly. No, for us, it's more of a showcase because we have this building and then this Metaverse is more like a gamification experience. So we bought this building and then we're going to have a fashion show in real life, and then we're going to replicate the fashion show in the building.

Or if we have an installation...

[Speaker 1] (41:13 - 41:54)

Has anyone here played Grand Theft Auto 5? And now 6 is going to come out at some point. Have you played 3 or 4?

You've got to play 5. And 5 has a multiplayer mode. Are you talking about the one on your phone or on an actual system?

No, on an actual system. So 5 has a multiplayer mode where anyone can create a server and over a thousand people can come in on the server. And when you enter the server, you can choose what your occupation is going to be.

Once you get in on the server, you can choose a job or you can start a business and you can actually do the business. And you have a bank account and real people who are in the city. Not a real bank account, but real people in the city.

[Speaker 2] (41:55 - 41:56)

And these are other users?

[Speaker 1] (41:56 - 44:16)

These are other users. Do you think at some point that bank accounts will become a real bank account? It's possible.

It's possible that they might tokenize it or each dollar in the game is worth something in the real world. It's like Second Life, that was also a game, but it's really advanced. And people actually roleplay.

So the multiplayer version of GTA is called GTA roleplay. It's where you actually roleplay. And the rules of the server are that if you stop roleplaying, you get booted out.

So people come in, they choose a character, they talk in an accent, they'll go to a store and people stream this online all the time. This is the closest thing to the metaphors that already exist that I've seen. Like there are people who stream this for my wife.

And there's another person somewhere in Aurangabad who in the game have married each other and they continue the story. This behavior already exists. Sorry, just wanted to take a break to appreciate GTA 5.

Since you both have experience in social media, how do you guys think social media will adopt the metaphors? So I think a couple of things. I think first social media has to unlearn what it knows, which is social media is all about control for the platform.

It's all about making money on... Metaphors will be about the control of the two platforms. Well, let's hope not.

Unless, unless Microsoft wins that race and then it's a very different world because they're always going to be a platform, a tech provider versus owning an end-user experience. And they've stayed away from it till date, quite consciously. So if you think about it...

In Satya we trust. In Satya we trust, totally. So I think they have to unlearn a lot because in the social world you own the consumer, you own his data, you monetize his or her data and in the metaverse you really don't own the consumer.

It's on blockchain. No, no, metaverse is not necessarily on the blockchain. Like the game I was

playing last night, Echo, on Oculus, on Meta's platform.

It's owned by them, right?

[Speaker 2] (44:16 - 44:57)

It's owned by them. Everything is theirs. So what I think will happen is there will be multiple people trying out different use cases of the metaverse.

One person will do communication, another will do gaming, third one will do just fashion. So all of this. And somebody else will say I'll just create the world.

Like I can attend a concert or whatever. The guy who cracks the highest frequency use case in the metaverse gets the opportunity to own all the low frequency use cases after that.

[Speaker 1] (44:57 - 47:47)

What do we think? We all have to wager a guess. What do we suspect the first use case will be?

I think it makes sense because chat is insanely popular. Communication, yeah. Because basic communication and the randomness.

How original do we look? I'm shaking my hand and expressing myself in a certain manner. How much does that pass on into the metaverse?

Prashant will be able to answer that. You guys need to check out Haptics. The latest CES show had some really cool The first one is Jacket and a Pant that you wear on.

It transmits your full body feedback onto the metaverse. If I give you a hug sitting in New York. Have you guys seen this movie Ready Player One?

Yes. In the movie, this guy orders the X1 suit and so we're almost there. I think 5G is one thing and then I'm betting big on Apple to change things on the AR and Prashant and Marco we're going to put you on the spot a little bit.

Name one company you would bet on which is publicly listed and people can invest in to take advantage of the metaverse and you can name one publicly listed company. Okay, so on the consumer side there is no metaverse company which has any substantial lead. There are infrastructure players and these can be identified by engineering heads owning or building different components but on the enterprise side it's no doubt Microsoft.

Microsoft more than Meta? Microsoft better than Meta? Yeah, Meta is screwed.

John Carmack resigned last week. Until John Carmack was there I was having some hope for Meta but after he resigned there's no hope. There's no tangible VR tech guy or metaverse tech

guy within Meta's leadership right now.

You have stock? How do you feel about NVIDIA? That's the infrastructure player I'm talking about.

You have people like that NVIDIA and maybe IQI from China or anyone who's manufacturing hardware those guys are going to do fine. For both Metaverse and crypto. Because NVIDIA is basically everyone buying everything.

This is the worst time to talk about crypto.

[Speaker 4] (47:48 - 47:49)

I know, it's a bad word.

[Speaker 1] (47:53 - 48:00)

I don't think there will be any lead until at least one or two years after Apple launches their VR devices.

[Speaker 2] (48:01 - 48:22)

Another reason why I think Meta won't do well in the metaverse is because everything that they've done well after Facebook is something they bought. Everything they've tried to do on their own I don't think they've done well at all. So, their strategy is to keep an eye out on which is the next company that will do well on metaverse and then buy it.

[Speaker 1] (48:23 - 48:56)

The other controversial view is that any web 1.0 company was terrible to has never built a great web 2.0 product or even a company. And I don't see any current web That's because between 2010 and 2022 we haven't seen any substantial innovation. It's because good times create weak men and it's been great times for the last 15 years.

So, no real innovation has actually happened. Also guys, we all are disclosing that we may or may not have shares in any of the companies.

[Speaker 2] (48:59 - 49:03)

No, no, mine is totally organic. It's all names that are popping up in my head.

[Speaker 1] (49:03 - 49:13)

I have no meta shares left. But remember there's only one man who professionally trades. It's always important to have disclosures.

[Speaker 3] (49:14 - 50:11)

If I may give my opinion on meta, why it won't succeed in the metaverse, it's because they stuck in 2010 and now it's 2012. But they don't understand the concept of the metaverse. The metaverse is also democracy.

It's like democratization of the creation phase, of the usage. If you go to Sandbox and you create your own collection, you get 85% of the sales. Sandbox will just take a fee.

They will take 85% and the creator will take 15%. That's the problem. The second thing is why do I need to have my virtual avatar that looks like me if I have to play around with my imagination in the metaverse?

Yes, I can have my replica, but it's just like a little bit lame. Sorry for the word.

[Speaker 1] (50:12 - 51:37)

No one was talking to me about the concept of buying watches. Why does somebody buy a Rolex? If somebody buys a Rolex in the real world, why not spend on an NFT in the virtual world?

I'm not able to digest that logic yet. This behavior already exists. There's the most expensive CSGO skin.

CSGO is a very popular game, the most expensive skin. CS is Counter Strike? Not in the last five years, but for a good 10 years in a row.

Me, Nitin, 4-5 other guys, we have played Counter Strike every day in office, on the network, for a minimum of 3-4 hours. You never bought a skin? No, back then it was Counter Strike 1.6. Yeah, so the most expensive skin currently is going for some 800,000 dollars, which is nothing but a spray on a gun, and there is a marketplace for this that keeps the royalty of this. So this behavior, 100% exists, like buying something for a world where you can signal in a world that you spend a lot of time. People are going to buy your house.

[Speaker 2] (51:38 - 51:46)

If I'm going to live there 18 hours a day and sleep in the real world, then I'm going to stop spending in the real world and only spend there.

[Speaker 1] (51:47 - 55:47)

I've spent 25,000 bucks on a game called Vandit, that I play every day for an hour. This is real, and people will do it. It's just for a profile picture.

Another question, I got an Oculus and I was playing Echo last night, and I woke up today and I had this massive pain in my neck and everything. How does that change? Because when you're

in a device and you're not doing things which are natural to you for more than a few hours, how does the body cope with that?

Prashant, this is for you. It's mostly the hardware form factor. People have not solved the fine balance that you need to take care of in a decent VR device.

So there's a lot of weight in the front of your head, but there needs to be a counterweight to balance on the back. Yeah, you end up like this, and you don't realize you're like this for two hours in a row. So it's the first time in your life your muscles are used to carrying a two-pound weight on the forehead.

So I think some of the VR devices I sent across had a counterweight to balance on the back. Someone mentioned NVL glasses. Glasses coming out with that kind of form factor solves it.

Have you tried those? I haven't tried them, but I've tried other MR glasses, but I understand they're pretty cool. Yeah, what really solves this is 5G, right?

Why is the headset heavy? Because the headset is carrying a display, a processor, a GPU, a networking thing, a battery pack, and this whole... Once 5G is supporting consistent bandwidth of 500 Mbps and above, you're just carrying a display on your lens and everything is just streamed.

The processing is always done on the cloud or maybe on your mobile phone for that reason. You need to separate the processor, GPU, battery from the display. When that happens, the form factor becomes better.

So it's a combination of two things. It's a combination of not only 5G, which I think is super critical to your point, but also the cost of compute coming down exponentially in the back end. It's really expensive otherwise.

Even if you have 5G today, 5G is now a reality. There are a billion people on the planet who are on 5G, of the six billion who are connected or five billion who are connected. But the back-end compute is so expensive with Amazon and Google and Microsoft making money on that compute.

That has to come down significantly as well. I'll slightly differ on that topic. The back-end compute part, this is where gaming companies who have a gaming engine have a massive advantage.

Take, for example, a game of Counter-Strike. You have 10 people playing around and shooting bullets which are travelling at ridiculous speeds. Compare a 30-second or one-minute session of this game to a one-minute session of a user on Amazon.

The amount of information being parsed in a one-minute session is ridiculously high compared to an Amazon session. Amazon is clicking five times in a On Counter-Strike, it has to be 10 milliseconds or 20 milliseconds. When you shoot a bullet, the guy has to die immediately.

For example, in a game, if you are here and I'm here and I shoot and sometimes as a player, if my internet is weak, the bullet I've obviously shot you, but you're not dead in the game. So my ping is high, which means the time it takes to show your location to me is taking way longer.

[Speaker 2] (55:47 - 55:56)

You know, I read this article where this guy has created in the metaverse where if you die in the game, you die in real.

[Speaker 1] (55:56 - 55:57)

It's not real.

[Speaker 2] (55:58 - 56:06)

That can't be real, dude. No, so he's created that experience. I'm sure nobody's going through it yet.

But he's saying you play this game. If you die in the game, you die in real.

[Speaker 4] (56:06 - 56:07)

It's like Squid Games.

[Speaker 2] (56:08 - 56:09)

It's like Squid Games.

[Speaker 1] (56:10 - 1:02:27)

It's like Squid Games. Any of you guys have watched anime? There's this anime called Sword Art Online.

It's based in the future and... But why am I not sure if you watch anime? No, this has been like enlightening.

Can I tell you, you guys have thought more about the metaverse than we could find online. Have you seen the videos online? There was nothing.

There was just confusion. Anyway, thank you guys so much. Thank you.

Thank you so much Prashant and Marko. Bye guys. Okay, guys, let's welcome Himanshu, who created India's first virtual influencer called Kaira.

I have a question. Why did choose the name Kaira? So we didn't want to be political or religious.

So we didn't give her a surname because we wanted to get the most amount of audience possible. So that's why it's a very neutral name. It's a very trendy name.

So we have also recently launched a South Indian virtual influencer. Her name is Shravya. So we have a fellow from Andhra and he says that Shravya is the most trending name right now in the South.

So it's not like a very calculated decision. It's a team of content creators coming up with these names. But Kaira sounds like a virtually name right?

Yeah. And why did you create a girl? Because we have five guys on this table.

So we are working on a guy as well, on a virtual influencer. No, it makes sense because if he's created an influencer in India where there's a male-dominated population on the internet and if you want followers and viewers, there are going to be more men following a woman. Is that true on social media?

I mean, I know it's true but I want to know how true since you guys are on social media. If you were a cute girl who posted pictures online, what are the odds of getting more likes? I'm not talking about people like us.

What are the odds? So I've asked a bunch of my friends who are, you know, some of these are girls who are in fashion. So one of the things I ask is, can I see your audience on Instagram to see the breakup?

Very, very rarely do I see an equal split. In fact, I think probably twice I've seen it but more often than not it is male-dominated. I'm sure there are numbers to prove this as well.

Even when we started, Kyra had 90% male audience, 10% female. So we worked very hard through marketing, through, like, reaching out. We actually marketed a lot through memes.

So all these meme pages that have 10 million followers on Instagram. And what's the ratio now? Now the ratio is 70-30.

So we were surprised that a lot of females follow meme pages as well. So what does Kyra do? Like, is she a character on one of the metaverses we spoke about?

Is it on Facebook's metaverse? Kyra exists there? Right.

So Kyra is a virtual influencer. There is no such person that exists. And Kyra is a virtually 3D-created character that we have created.

She can go, theoretically, she can go to any metaverse. Where does she live? Where does she spend her time?

Her story, so we are really focused on storytelling. Her story is that in January of 2022, she came from the metaverse to our world and she lost her memories. So she came to the digital world.

Now she's on a journey to rediscover her memories. Where does she come from? So we haven't told that origin story yet, what is her original metaverse, but we have tried Kyra in different metaverses.

So we have tried with Decentraland. We recently did something with MG Motors. So they have created their own MG-verse and we got Kyra into that for the auto export.

Just out of curiosity, is it a two-way conversation? How do I talk to Kyra? Currently Kyra is static, so it's a very curated content.

No audio, she doesn't talk? She talks, we have a voice actress. There's no interactivity right now.

That's the thing that we are working on. The next step will be to make her semi-autonomous. And how does Kyra make money?

MG Motors? We have worked with six brands and we actually have more requests than we have the production capacity for, but we don't want to be standing for... You don't have to answer this if you don't want to, but how much does a brand like that pay someone like Kyra?

I don't know how much following Kyra has. So currently Kyra has 200k followers. Typically you get 10,000 on one particular social media platform.

On Instagram, we are working on her music album for YouTube. So we have hired a production team. We're quite happy with the song that they have produced.

We're quite excited to launch her. So all the... So there is a very popular virtual influencer called Lil Mikayla.

She's in the US. She has 3 million followers. She's 19 years old and she has her music albums.

And her music videos get 5 million views plus 10 million views. And almost all virtual influencers have some sort of music angle. But tell me this.

When I'm looking at Kyra online, I know it's not a real person. I know it's not her voice. In her album, I know it's not her singing.

What is the incentive or why do people follow virtual influencers? So when we... It's character and storytelling, right?

It's like saying Harry Potter isn't real and why are there Potter heads? It's like saying Sherlock Holmes isn't real. Because there was a movie which popularized them.

Yeah, so similarly, social media is like you're building the story out, right? Now tomorrow Kyra could meet a nice guy. So in a way, everything on social media is essentially a story.

Do you think movies will go there? Yeah. Like we've had 3D movies and stuff, right?

Like you wear those glasses. Have you seen Jurassic Park on Oculus? No.

You should watch it. It's pretty nuts. Is it interactive?

Like can you do stuff with the characters? Not yet. Not yet.

So they have a 2-3 minute movie of Jurassic Park inside the Oculus where if you look around, there's a dinosaur behind you, there's one in front of you. But imagine if they have haptics and you can touch the dinosaurs. That'll be the next step.

Yeah. Why do you want to touch dinosaurs?

[Speaker 2] (1:02:31 - 1:02:35)

It's rubbish British dude. Look at what all we're discovering tonight.

[Speaker 1] (1:02:35 - 1:03:24)

What a weirdo. Can you imagine a lizard on the wall at What a weirdo. Have you tried integrating ChartGPT with it?

I was just thinking it'll make sense. So we're on the hunt for a CTO. That's the first thing that we want to do.

We have figured out that. We all are very obliged. Himanshu flew all the way from Delhi to Bangalore for tonight.

I suddenly feel worse for you dude. My condolences. Thank you so much.

That was very kind. Guys, if any tech folks are watching this, please do apply. Link should be in the description.

But you're in the right city. My friend was just joking that every corner there's a founder and a CEO. Of course.

You should spend one or two days and meet a bunch of people.

[Speaker 4] (1:03:25 - 1:03:26)

There's five on this table.

[Speaker 1] (1:03:26 - 1:04:08)

So we are currently meeting VCs right now because we have scaled it so far. Although we I'm not a VC. Small engine.

Small engine. Are you using Unreal Engine for it? We have ported Kaira to Unreal Engine.

We're still figuring out the details but we believe Unreal Engine is the way to go. So there are two pipelines. One is the animation pipeline which is you see Pixar movies and one is the gaming pipeline.

Currently animation pipeline is more photorealistic. But Unreal Engine is catching up. So what is the moat going to be?

Story? We want it to be story. So we cannot compete with Unreal.

We cannot put billions of dollars into making the next 3D company.

[Speaker 2] (1:04:09 - 1:04:12)

So how are real influencers actually reacting to this?

[Speaker 1] (1:04:13 - 1:04:16)

Have you asked them what a real influencer is reacting right now?

[Speaker 2] (1:04:16 - 1:04:17)

No no.

[Speaker 1] (1:04:17 - 1:05:19)

The I have like How many videos are you Especially the women. Right. So we did something with both.

So they were launching their ANC neckband. And Kaira was the face of the campaign. So we most likely replaced some influencer that was going to be the face of the campaign with Kaira.

How dare you. It's hard enough with the recession coming. They think all jobs are good.

All jobs are good. Tell me a few jobs which were not good. The guys were creating all this.

Like AI operators. Oh somebody is going to create. It's mostly like a lot of these are we are still at the But like with most of technology it's like it's almost there, almost there, almost there.

And then one day it's like wink. It's like alright now have your job. So who used to code?

[Speaker 2] (1:05:19 - 1:05:19)

Yeah.

[Speaker 1] (1:05:20 - 1:05:21)

Now anybody can code.

[Speaker 2] (1:05:22 - 1:05:22)

Yeah.

[Speaker 1] (1:05:25 - 1:05:48)

It is really cool. It's too cheap is what I think. 42 hours is too cheap.

It will go up. There is a pro version. I'm like it's too cheap.

Everyone's writing ads so easily. Write an ad like Tanmay Bhat. Okay.

[Speaker 2] (1:05:52 - 1:05:52)

No.

[Speaker 1] (1:05:52 - 1:06:03)

But for example. The data set is still 2021. So they are making GPT-4.

Currently it's even in the pro version. So all the training data it has been given. It's still 2021.

[Speaker 2] (1:06:03 - 1:06:04)

That's all temporary problems.

[Speaker 1] (1:06:06 - 1:11:24)

They are actually making GPT. So this is 3 or 3.5. They are making GPT-4. Can I be honest?

I was surprised. Maybe I did not understand. But I found it interesting.

Yeah. So there will be professions like prompt engineers are going to be a thing. Yeah.

Like there was some specific way for you to prompt. Like there are already websites where you can buy prompts. Where there are certain prompts that deliver certain kinds of images on Dolly.

So I have bought. I have spent like $50 buying different prompts. I was like okay.

So for example this guy. I wanted to make some logos. And this guy had figured out a way to

make these nice beautiful 3Dish logos.

And I said okay. I want a logo in 3D. So I went and paid $9.

I got the prompt. And then I am able to use it in Dolly. And I made a logo.

Creating the prompt will become the skill. 100%. Prompt engineers are going to be a thing.

Absolutely. Yeah. Oh yeah.

So not just chat GPD. AI in general. So currently if you have to create a 3D world.

So something there is a concept of a metaverse called a digital twin. Whatever exists in the real world there will be a digital twin of it. See all is actually launching a virtual Seoul.

South Korea is working on it. There is a tool called NERF. It's neural radiance field.

So just with a smartphone you can capture this room. And you will create a 3D version of it. Previously it was done using very complex cameras, very high resolution photos.

The use cases are amazing right. If you think about it. Gaming and entertainment is a no-brainer.

Of course. But education, learning, medicine man. Oh yeah.

Through the pandemic we all fell ill. Zoom felt like chat GPD back then. We are getting a lot of pro Microsoft dialogues in this conversation.

Zoom is not though. Microsoft is also coming to Meta. Microsoft teams and office is coming to Facebook's version of Meta.

It looks awful. That doesn't look good. In the short term it will benefit folks who already have leverage.

If I'm a hospital and I have 50 chains across the world and I have all this data about these smokers who come into the hospital and these are the problems that smokers have. So now if I have AI I basically have data that I can use to train this AI model and that can start spitting out saying based on the data this is how you should probably treat the next thing. If you have the leverage of data in the short term at least you have a significant leg up in the AI world.

We also believe that everything does not need to be on the Metaverse. It's not necessary that you get everything. For example, so it's ease of convenience.

So let's say you have to put out a tweet or a coup. It's very easy to pull out your phone and type it out but in a Metaverse you have to wear the headset, you go into a 3D world. So the convenience actually decreases.

I think we are assuming that the hardware will evolve so quickly that it will be like your glasses at some point in the near future. What do you think from a climate change standpoint? Do you think Metaverse is the answer?

Wow. This is a question above my pay grade. There's a lot of computing power that goes into building this infrastructure.

That's not good for the environment. But if you were to compare, say I had to go travel to Saudi Arabia for a meeting in two days. If I can do the meeting in a manner like we're sitting next to each other, can you really equate the computing cost with the plane ride, the cost of the taxi ride, the fuel, all of But it doesn't feel like you're with each other.

You know Zoom does not feel like this. Like the four of us could have done this on Zoom but it wouldn't have been the same. I think as compute gets more efficient, it definitely is a greener solution.

If the applicability is around, let's say commute, shopping, meetings, interactions, I don't know if it's the answer, but it's definitely far better in terms of reducing carbon emissions. Of course, you're right that even compute has to get more green. I mean, in the sense, in so many ways.

But it's definitely a step forward. I think that's a big thing to ponder over, right? Like today when it is a possibility, we are thinking, but tomorrow when it becomes an inevitability, do we all switch very quickly to be more efficient with how we use energy around this?

I think the path to go there will consume a lot of energy, but if you compare sequences, then it might. For example, creating an electric car that actually uses a lot of emissions, but using it does not.

[Speaker 4] (1:11:24 - 1:11:26)

We're planning to have a conversation about that.

[Speaker 1] (1:11:27 - 1:11:51)

Yes. Probably on that note. Yeah.

Should we call it? Yeah. Did we all like, do you all want to like do one conclusion, what we got from today's discussion?

I'd like to do one. Yeah. Like, share, and subscribe to this new channel.

Nikhil is going to sit down with many more friends who are incredibly smart, who can come answer our dumb questions.

[Speaker 2] (1:11:51 - 1:12:12)

Yeah, I think Metaverse is definitely the future. Some of the most important things will go there and, you know, we'll probably become less human because the friction to actually meet somebody in person will be much higher. Right?

If you can get everything at home, you know.

[Speaker 1] (1:12:12 - 1:12:55)

Oh man, the number of times people will cancel plans now. Already it's pretty bad. Yeah.

Imagine the amount of time you save in commute and all of that. You just like run into each other, right? Just cancel your Saudi flight, man.

I just think that, you know, only the most important things in life will be real. Everything else, Metaverse, some online thing, some automated shit. Imagine if you start living in a virtual world, then you'll have kids in the virtual world as well.

Yeah, you'll get delivered somewhere. Why does your mind go to population every single time? I think it's quickly becoming one of the biggest problems on the planet, right?

We're not reproducing enough.

[Speaker 2] (1:12:57 - 1:12:59)

The only problem India doesn't have.

[Speaker 1] (1:13:00 - 1:14:19)

Why don't you reproduce? Huh? I'm waiting for you.

Alright, this is a good time to end it. Hey, wait. We have a few more.

I think, you know, experiences at the end of the day are goosebumps, right? And technology is just an enabler to drive those goosebumps. And I think Metaverse will provide those moments.

And technology will provide those moments. But I'm a big believer in this. But nothing replaces this, right, at the end of the day.

I think these experiences will get utilitarian. These experiences will help with conveniences. These experiences will help with healthcare, financial services, travel, experiencing, you know, even an F1 race or an IPL cricket game if you can't travel.

But at the end of the day, I think nothing will replace human interaction in the physical world. Because there is that need. We are a social being.

And nothing replaces this, right? Why don't you guys go check out Kyra? It's Kyra Onig on

Instagram.

Tell us if our babies would be good-looking. See you next time. Okay, thank you all for watching.

Bye-bye. Thank you. I'm playing Beat Saber.

Right? Dude, did you know you had a body in this? Beat Saber there.

[Speaker 2] (1:14:20 - 1:14:26)

I can see my hands. I suddenly saw my legs. It's a little weird.

And I also saw my crotch.

[Speaker 1] (1:14:28 - 1:14:47)

How do you make sure your head is straight when you don't bend down? That's because I have spinal strength. How do I get out of YouTube by then?

What are you watching?

[Speaker 2] (1:14:52 - 1:14:59)

I have a search. Oh! Oh!

Oh! Beautiful. I love this man.